

COMP3540 – HUMAN COMPUTER INTERACTION AND DESIGN

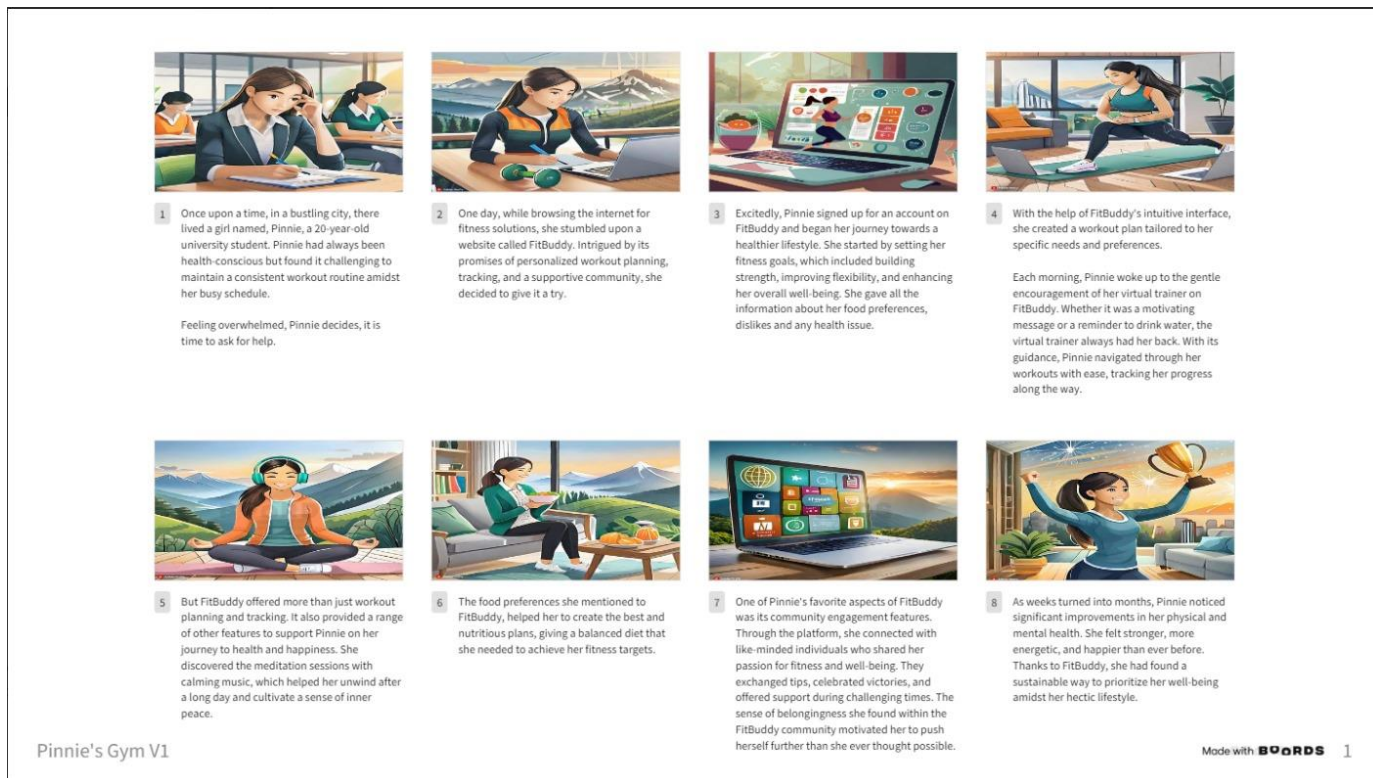
TEAM PROJECT PHASE #2: DESIGNING ALTERNATIVES

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Part 1: Scenario and Storyboard:

Pinnie, a 20-year-old university student, loves working out and really wants to be healthier. However, like many people, she struggles to understand and manage fitness routines, diets, and mental health on her own. Feeling overwhelmed, Pinnie decides, it is time to look for help. One day, while surfing the internet looking for alternatives, she came across a website called FitBuddy. She was interested in all the fitness solutions it promised, so she signed up right away. Pinnie believed that FitBuddy would be an ideal partner to help her achieve her fitness goals. Therefore, she begins her journey by creating a profile on FitBuddy. She provides information about her fitness goals, food preferences and dislikes, and any health issues she may have. With FitBuddy's easy-to-use interface, she can create a workout plan that suits her schedule and fitness level. She tries out various exercise plans from the pre-recorded sessions of trainers and coaches, while closely monitoring her progress. She starts noticing positive changes in her energy levels and overall well-being. Pinnie really likes the meditation sessions on the platform. It helps her deal with stress and stay mentally focused even during her busy days. Eager to learn more about FitBuddy's community features, she joins different fitness groups and takes part in challenges. Encouraged and supported by other users with similar fitness goals as her, Pinnie actively participates in conversations with her friends, shares achievements, and receives valuable guidance from the educational sections. As Pinnie approached the end of her goal that she set upon signing up, FitBuddy reflected upon her progress along with stats and celebrated the milestones she has achieved by awarding her with badges that are displayed on her profile. Through consistently working out, eating well, and the support of FitBuddy platform and community, she has made great progress towards reaching her fitness goals. With FitBuddy as her companion, she feels more confident and empowered to keep going on her fitness journey. Pinnie's experience with FitBuddy shows how technology can help enhance health and wellness. By offering a variety of features, personalized guidance, and a supportive community, FitBuddy has not only helped Pinnie reach her fitness objectives but has also fostered a sense of belonging and empowerment in her pursuit of a healthier lifestyle.

Storyboard:



Source: [Free Storyboard Software | Boords](https://www.boords.com/)

Part 2:

Link for prototype.

<https://www.figma.com/file/SO3hEV31u2SXVV1oC29oWa/FITBUDDY-PROTOTYPE?type=design&node-id=0-1&mode=design&t=tZjKFvuXXIAxuxe3-0>

Reasons for our design choices:

1. Comprehensive Feature Set and Personalization

The FitBuddy prototype offers a broad range of features, including customizable workout plans, nutritional guidance, and mental health resources, catering to diverse user needs and fitness levels. This design choice supports inclusivity, ensuring the app is accessible and valuable to a wide audience. By allowing users to tailor their fitness journey, FitBuddy enhances user engagement and satisfaction, providing a personalized experience that motivates users to achieve their health goals.

2. Engagement and Motivation Mechanisms

FitBuddy integrates gamification elements like achievements, challenges, and a social leaderboard, leveraging these to foster user engagement and motivation. This approach is rooted in HCI's focus on understanding user behavior to design for sustained use. By creating a competitive and supportive community environment, FitBuddy encourages regular interaction with the app, making the fitness journey enjoyable and socially rewarding.

3. Educational Resources and Mental Health Support

Incorporating educational content and mental health support, FitBuddy addresses the holistic well-being of its users. This design choice acknowledges the importance of supporting users beyond mere physical fitness. By providing valuable health information and resources for mental wellness, FitBuddy empowers users with knowledge in form of articles and tools to maintain a balanced lifestyle, enhancing the overall user experience.

4. Feedback and Progress Tracking

FitBuddy's detailed feedback and progress tracking features ensure users are constantly informed about their achievements and areas for improvement. This design choice aligns with importance of keeping users informed and engaged. By visually representing progress and offering constructive feedback, FitBuddy motivates users to continue their fitness journey, reinforcing positive behaviors and outcomes.

5. User-Centered Design and Usability

The prototype prioritizes a user-centered design approach, focusing on usability to ensure the app is intuitive and easy to navigate. This choice reflects HCI principles highlighting the importance of designing with the user in mind. By conducting user testing and incorporating feedback into the design process, we want to ensure that the app meets real user needs and preferences, enhancing user satisfaction and adoption.

Part 3:

How to use the prototype:

Welcome to FitBuddy, your everyday fitness companion. Here is how to navigate our app for an optimal experience:

Home Page Overview: Upon opening FitBuddy, user will be greeted by the home page, which provides a snapshot of your daily fitness metrics using convenient widgets. This includes your Active Calories, Exercise Minutes, and Stand Hours, displayed in an easy-to-read graphical interface. Additionally, you can check your Sleep Analysis and Steps for the day. Rest of the home page shows various navigation options to go into rest of the pages of the app.

Workout Features: Select the 'Workout' tab to access a variety of exercise routines categorized by type, such as strength training, HIIT, or cardio, etc. You can initiate a new workout (design your custom workout) or revisit recent ones under 'Recent Workouts.'

Nutritional Tracking: Under the 'Nutrition' section, you have the functionality to log daily food intake, view calorie counts using widget along with an easily accessible water tracking widget, and plan meals. A library of recipes is available to assist with healthy eating choices. Users can also access their nutritional insights based on their meal plan history.

Mental Health Resources: The 'Mental Health' area offers tools for managing stress, including guided meditations, and breathing exercises. Additionally, it contains informative resources (support from professionals) and a personal journal feature to support your mental well-being.

Social Engagement: Engage with your friends and rest of the community via the 'Leaderboard,' where you can compare your progress with others and participate in challenges to motivate and enhance your fitness journey. Users can also start their own challenges or access their friends' list from this section.

Progress Monitoring: The 'Progress' tab is where you can review your fitness achievements over time. It displays various statistics and records, including activity trends, personal records, and changes in body measurements.

Educational Content: 'Edu-Articles' provides a selection of articles ranging from fitness and nutrition advice to motivational stories, helping users stay informed and inspired. It caters to various kinds of users, so everybody has something that could help them.

Collective feedback from 10 potential users:

- App highly beneficial for quick workouts; fits easily into busy schedules.
- Workouts are efficient and the app is user-friendly, allowing easy navigation.
- Significant for those looking to maintain fitness with minimal planning/time.
- Meal planning component needs improvement; found to be complex and not straightforward.

- Although meal selection is simplified with checkboxes, lacks variety in quick, healthy meal options.
- Fitness beginner found guided workouts helpful with clear, step-by-step instructions and motivational milestones.
- Felt overwhelmed by the vast array of workout options, making it difficult to decide where to start.
- Appreciated nutrition information but found it too extensive to absorb initially.
- Suggests simplifying the app's approach to help new users navigate options more easily.
- Health enthusiast impressed with detailed progress tracking and wide workout range.
- Desired more flexibility in customizing workouts and meal plans for specific goals and preferences.
- Limited meal customization and lack of advanced workout options restricted full app tailoring.
- Valued comprehensive tracking and workout variety but recommended enhanced customization features for added value.
- Weight loss focus found structured diet/workout plans and motivational challenges beneficial.
- Felt app's generic goal setting lacked personalized feedback for individual needs and progress.
- Suggested more customized goal setting and adjustments based on personal achievements for enhanced effectiveness in weight loss journey.
- Competitive athlete valued detailed performance analytics and competitive leaderboard for progress tracking and motivation.
- Found the app's general workout routines lacking in sport-specific customization crucial for training.
- Nutritional advice did not meet the specific needs of high-performance athletes.
- Recommended the app to include more tailored workouts and nutrition advice for specialized disciplines, despite excelling in competitive features and analytics.
- Sessions served as a great start for mental wellness journey.
- Noted limited variety and depth in mental wellness options, desired more.
- Suggested access to a broader range of practices and deeper engagement for stress relief and mental health improvement.
- App offers a solid foundation with its meditation guides but needs to expand offerings for comprehensive mental wellness support.

Part 4:

Analysis of the feedback:

As our prototype is fairly low fidelity, so we were constantly explaining the potential users what they could expect off the real app or a comparable version where a lot of functions are running as intended, or what each of these features to include. Due to this reason the users also based their feedback on the extended understanding of what the feature set includes.

The Fitbuddy prototype gives valuable details about the app's features, how it is used, and what can be improved. These insights come from different users' feedback with varying needs and fitness goals. The user feedback should be used to understand both the strengths and drawbacks of the prototype, so that it can be developed further to make it more versatile and user-friendly.

Strengths Identified Across various random users:

- **Guided Workouts:** Users, especially beginners, appreciate the guided workouts because they provide clear instructions and motivational milestones, helping them start and maintain their fitness journey.
- **Time-Friendly Workouts:** The app considers those who have limited time but want an effective workout. It is designed to allow for quick and easy workouts, making it accessible to busy individuals.
- **Comprehensive Tracking-** Enables health enthusiasts to track their progress and achievements. - Competitive athletes can use it to monitor their advancements and set goals. - Motivates users through leaderboards and challenges.
- **Mental Wellness Focus-** The platform offers a curated selection of meditation and yoga sessions. Promotes mental well-being and mindfulness. Serves as an accessible starting point for users new to meditation and yoga.

Areas for Improvement and Recommendations:

- **Intuitive interface:** Clear, concise instructions keep beginners on track, empowering them to achieve their health goals.
- **Stay Motivated:** Motivation is key to maintaining a healthy lifestyle. Simplifying's personalized recommendations, progress tracking, and supportive community keep you engaged and motivated to stay on course. Whether you are just starting or looking to take your health to the next level, Simplifying is the perfect companion to help you thrive.
- **Expanded Content Variety:** Users seeking mental wellness support and those focused on weight loss express a need for a broader range of practices and deeper levels of

engagement. Similarly, competitive athletes and health enthusiasts look for more sport-specific workouts and nutritional advice tailored to high-performance needs.

- **Meal Planning and Nutritional Guidance:** The feedback points to a need for improvement in the meal planning component, emphasizing simplicity, variety, and specificity in dietary options to cater to a wider range of nutritional needs and preferences.

Description of issues faced by users:

Based on the helpful comments and ideas from our users, studying what users want and need, we found four primary areas to make better: Improving goal setting and feedback, improving on mental wellbeing offerings, catering to more advanced users or sports-specific users, and providing support and a community for rehabilitation. Our goal is to improve the FitBuddy experience by focusing on these aspects, helping users reach their health and fitness goals.

Enhanced Goal Setting and Feedback:

Setting goals is a key part of good fitness management. However, we know that general goals may not always appeal to each person specifically. To solve this, we are creating a goal-setting system in FitBuddy that is more tailored to each person. We will use advanced computer programs and information about users to customize goals based on what each person likes, can do, and wants to achieve. Our goal-setting system is designed to help you achieve your specific health and fitness goals, whether it is losing weight, gaining muscle, or improving endurance.

Additionally, we understand how important it is for users to get feedback that is timely and relevant to help them reach their goals. To achieve this goal, we are adding a feedback system to FitBuddy. This system will look at how well a user is doing right now and give them helpful tips and changes to help them improve. Our feedback system will give helpful advice as you make changes to your workouts, diet, and exercise techniques.

Sport-Specific and Advanced Workouts:

Fitness is different for everyone, especially for people who are into certain sports or want to do intense workouts. Realizing this, FitBuddy is determined to create workouts that are customized for certain sports and for people who are at an advanced fitness level. By working together with athletes and coaches, we will make specific content to improve performance, prevent injuries, and get the best outcomes possible. FitBuddy offers personalized workout plans for runners, cyclists, and martial artists to meet their specific fitness goals.

Also, we recognize the need for tough and varied workouts that go beyond the limits and help us improve. That is why we are adding more intensive exercises to our gym library for people who are experienced in working out. FitBuddy will provide a variety of exercise options like high-intensity interval training (HIIT) and strength circuits to keep users motivated and getting better.

Support and Community for Rehabilitation:

Many people experience injuries on their fitness journey, which is unfortunate. FitBuddy will provide specific exercises for people in rehab to help them recover. Users will find specific exercise routines to help them recover from injuries like sprained ankles or shoulder injuries, and to prevent future injuries while improving strength and flexibility.

Also, FitBuddy is creating a helpful community within the app to support people going through rehabilitation, as they understand how important social support is in overcoming difficulties. Users can connect with others who are going through similar struggles, share their experiences, and receive support as they work towards recovering through forums, group challenges, and peer support networks.

At FitBuddy, we aim to help people live healthier and happier lives with personalized and innovative health and fitness options. By improving goal setting and feedback, offering tailored workouts, integrating outdoor activities, and providing support for recovery, we are ready to change the way people approach fitness.

According to the user feedback, the FitBuddy team acknowledges the significance of mental well-being in relation to overall health and fitness. Users will be able to improve their mental well-being by accessing a broader range of meditation sessions that offer different techniques and practices. Moreover, offering a range of programs with various levels of difficulty ensures that people with varying levels of experience can access material that is appropriate for them, regardless of whether they are beginners or experienced practitioners.

By making these improvements, FitBuddy strives to develop a more welcoming and encouraging atmosphere for users looking to focus on their mental well-being.

[END OF PHASE 3]